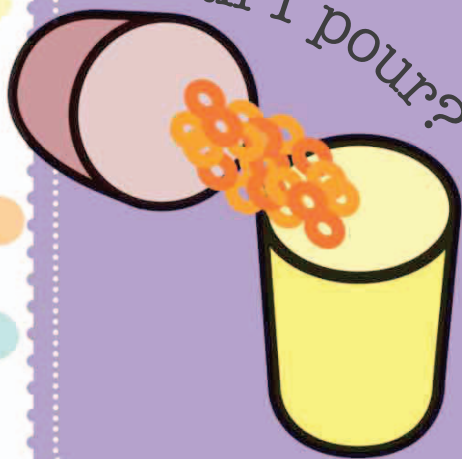


Shall I pour?



Sit on the floor on a blanket or cotton sheet with your baby. Put some dry, o-shaped cereal in two plastic, paper, or stacking cups. Show your baby how to pour the cereal from one cup to another and let him try to pour the cereal himself. It will take him many tries to get his hand coordination right, but he will love to spend time doing this activity and enjoy eating some of the cereal too.



Learning about feelings

The more animated you are when you talk about feelings with your baby, the more comfortable he will be expressing himself. Give his soft toy animal a hug to demonstrate how to show love, show the emotion on your face, and describe what you are doing and feeling. Then give him his toy to hug. Or, for example, say that the toy is happy to be reading with Daddy as you give your baby a big smile.

You can also use soft toys to act out the emotional content in story books: when a character reacts with feeling, stop reading and act out the emotion with a toy, showing the expression on your own face and emphasizing your body language as you talk.